

Exercise DEV ■ Development

Name: _____

Goals

1. Practice taking a *developmental neuroscience* perspective to psychological phenomena.
2. Illustrate how taking such a perspective does or does not inform understanding about a particular phenomenon.

Activity

1. Choose a psychological domain that interests you.
2. In the spirit of (Blumberg & Adolph, 2023), write a short essay (3-5 pp) where you apply a developmental neuroscience perspective to the domain. In doing so, concisely answer the following questions:
 - How does psychological functioning change over development?
 - What brain system(s) are most directly implicated in the phenomenon?
 - Does our current understanding of developmental patterns in these systems provide useful information about the domain?
 - What information about brain structure or function is needed to understand the phenomenon more thoroughly?

Submission details

- Submit your write-up by **2026-03-26** via the Canvas [dropbox](#).
- If you work with other people, please indicate the name(s) of your co-authors in your document. You need not include them in the document file name, however.
- If you found any resources that were especially useful to you in answering these questions, please cite them.

Blumberg, M. S., & Adolph, K. E. (2023). Protracted development of motor cortex constrains rich interpretations of infant cognition. *Trends in Cognitive Sciences*, 27(3), 233–245. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tics.2022.12.014>